Proposal for removing Casavant organ

This is a proposal for a 3-phase plan for removing the Casavant Frères Ltée., Opus 3091, organ from Trinity-by-the-Cove Episcopal Church before the building is demolished in late 2026.

The organ will be moved to my workshop in Winter Garden, FL. After restoration work, it will be paired with a new/refurbished console, and installed into a large building on our property that we will be dedicating to musical activities, eventually made available to students for practice or small recitals.

Daniel Horn – 425-577-3865 – dkhorn@gmail.com
3145 Avalon Rd, Winter Garden, FL

Phase 1: Removing most of the non-facade pipes

- **What**: I will pack up and remove all pipes under 8' in total length that are not immediately visible from the floor of the sanctuary.
    - Removing all the pipes from the Positiv chest (~300 pipes)
        - 8’ Bourdon (only 4’ physical length)
        - 4’ Flute a Fuseau
        - 2 2/3 Nasard
        - 2’ Doublette (TC…?)
        - 8’ Cromorne (4’ physical length)
    - Removing all 6 ranks from the big Great windchest (~580 pipes)
        - Mixture IV
        - Cornet II
        - 4’ Petite Flute
        - 4’ Prestant
        - 8’ Flute a Cheminee (4’ physical length)
        - and the upper octaves of the pedal's Octave unit rank
    - Removing all 10 ranks from the swell/Recit (~700 pipes)
        - 8' Fl. Doublette (excluding longest few)
        - 4' Prestant
        - Quarte mixture II
        - 8' Trumpet/clarion
        - 8' Bassoon/oboe
        - 8' Viole (excluding longest few)
        - 8' Fl. Douce (excluding longest few)
        - 4' Celeste

        - 4' Fl. Conique
        - Voix Humaine
    - **Leaving in place:** the Great Bourdon (front two rows on Positiv side); the pedal soubasse (large wood pipes); the lower two octaves of the pedal Octave Basse (front and center of the facade); the pedal Bombarde (center, second row); and the Great Montre (front two rows on Great side) - ~200 pipes
- **When**: Some time after Easter - perhaps May? Before the peak of summer, ideally.
- **How long**: I would like to do this in one (long) day, but may split it into two non-consecutive days depending on what I decide I can fit in one van load.
- **Who**: this will be mostly me, though I may recruit/hire a volunteer/helper for the latter half of the day
- **Impact to your congregation**:
    - During the work day: minorly disruptive - we will be up and down ladders around the mezzanine, passing pipes and boxes of pipes down from above, and carrying pipe trays out to my van. No special equipment, etc.
    - Once complete: Everything will be effectively back to "normal" unless somebody looks closely at the organ loft and notices the pipes missing from behind the facade.

Phase 2: Removing the remaining pipework, racking, and wind equipment

- **What**: I will return with a van configured for longer pieces, pack up and remove:
    - All the façade and pipework left over from the previous phase (~220 pipes):
        - Great Bourdon 16 (8' physical length)
        - Pedal soubasse 16 (8' stopped wood pipes)
        - Pedal Octave Basse 8' lower two octaves
        - Pedal bombarde 16 (8' physical length)
        - Greate Montre 8'
        - The few long pipes left in swell box from previous phase – from Doublette, Viole, and Fl. Douce
    - All of the rackboards and other racking hardware
    - Toeboards where possible
    - Auxilliary windchests from swell box (the voix humaine box on the wall and the conical flute chests on the opposite wall)

    - Time/space permitting: blower-room equipment: blower, swell-shade motors, reservoir
- **When**: Whenever you tell me it's okay to remove the facade, from an aesthetic perspective. Sooner is better - would rather not do this at the peak of summer if at all possible
- **How long**: One long day
- **Who**: Me and one or two helpers for the whole day
- **Impact to your congregation**:
    - During the work day: similar to phase 1 - we'll be up and down the ladders, just passing bigger pipes along.
    - Once complete: The organ loft will now appear completely empty from the perspective of the sanctuary floor. This will be a visual aesthetic impact only, but a big one.

Phase 3: Final removal

- **What**: I will return again with a large van and some specialized lift equipment, disassemble and remove all the remaining organ equipment, including:
    - Blower-room equipment (if left behind in previous phase)
    - Windchests - there are 7 of these in total, and they will likely be very heavy even after partially disassembling them in place
    - Swell shades
    - Windways/tubing
    - Peterson power/relay panel and wiring harnesses
    - Whatever else I haven't thought of...
- **When**: Sometime before you turn the lights (and AC) off for the last time before the wrecking ball - see the "impact" section below.
- **How long**: two consecutive days - fist day will be disassembling everything that can be disassembled, second day will be heavy lifting and loading.
- **Who**: Mostly me on the first day, plus 2-3 helpers on the second day for lifting the heavy chests
- **Impact to your congregation**:
    - First day: I'll have all the access panels open and/or removed, pulling things out from under the windchests. This will be a bit messy.

- Second day: I will almost certainly need to bring in a mechanical lift of some sort to get the windchests over the balcony rail and down to the floor - even with the most compact option, I think we'll need to move some pews out of the way at the very least.
- After work is complete: It depends on timing. This *could* be done in a way that puts everything back together at the end - access panels closed, etc.- and the only obvious change would be the gaping holes where the swell shades were. Structurally, the mezzanine floor will be "down to studs" at this point - the windchests *are* the floor. Of course, if this is immediately before demo starts, we could take some shortcuts and not worry about getting everything pretty again.

Why a multiphase approach spread out over time?

Why not just take a week and do this all at once right before demo? The short answer is that I'm not a professional organ technician (who would, incidentally, charge $15k or more for this extraction). There are several corollaries to the I'm-not-a-pro fact:

- I have a full time job and small children – since I live 3.5 hours away, it would be less than ideal for me to disappear for a whole week at once to do this removal in a single pass
- I don't know what I don't know. Multiple phases allows for larger readjustments in planning between steps – for example, if I discover during pipe removal something that will dramatically change my plan for windchest removal, I'll have plenty of time to modify the future phases.
- I don't have a large truck and am really not comfortable driving a rented one in unfamiliar downtown Naples or on the long trip home. I can fit most of this organ in my own van, cleverly packed, and can rent a slightly larger van for the trips with oversized pieces.
- I don't have a crew I can rely on to help for several days in a row – it will be much easier to line up helpers one day at a time.